

and a collection of naughty poems too!” Sreeram informs with some pride in his voice.

William Wordsworth has been one of the inspirations for Sreeram for the writing of poems. The poem titled ‘Daffodils’ is the one that is closest to his heart. Why? Because the theme of the poem is nature’s beauty with a mix of happiness and solitude. Wordsworth, in a pensive mood, often thinks of the daffodils swaying and dancing, portraying nature’s beauty, and feels happy and content.

Sreeram also happens to be a movie buff. His blogs somehow uncannily have references of movies and scenes that have inspired him. He was a blogger before he started writing poems. He says, he started blogging in the year 2007 and wrote about what was happening around him. One of his latest blogs (posted on LinkedIn) tries to define perfection, taking cue from the Hollywood blockbuster ‘The Matrix.’

“Many of us simply want to be perfect, or at least strive for perfection, only to grandly fail while several others, equally if not more perfectionist in their thinking and in their own personal lives, seem to move on, take things in stride and even progress in their life unaffected and unstressed,” Sreeram writes in that blog that ends with the lines inspired by The Matrix, “at what cost perfectionism when a lesser mind or a mind less bound by the parameters of perfection might perfectly do...”

He does not shy away from admitting that he responds to a lot of situations in his personal and professional life with one of the many favourite dialogues that have inspired him. The practice, as per him, helps him clarify situations to his colleagues and family in a better manner.

Cardiac stroke at young age

Sreeram was well settled in the United States when he had to take a call and move back to India in 1994. The main reason behind taking this call and leaving behind a good life in the USA was the simple fact that he wanted to be with his parents.

“That was a tough decision that I had to take. I also wanted to come back before my wife and I had kids.



In a meeting with former chief minister Ms. Jayalalitha

We were always sure that our kids will follow the good old Indian principles, and that is one of the other reasons we came back to India,” explains Sreeram.

He was able to land a job in a company which had been recently acquired by a TVS Group company. This company was burning cash and was waiting to be put back on the track of making profits. Sreeram explains that melting steel was a big part of the work this company did, and as he was hired for an R&D cum applications marketing role, Sreeram had to spend a lot of time next to furnaces where steel was being melted besides hitting the road often to meet customers.

“Six months into this new job and I found myself in an intensive cardiac care unit (ICCU) of a government hospital one evening. I had a very intense and unbearable pain in the chest and was unsure if I would survive the night. Somehow the very competent doctor found a way to keep me going and the company took great care of me at that time,” recalls Sreeram. “Many hospitals soon after wanted to cut me up citing complete blockage of my vessels. Fortunately, a very good doctor in Chennai cleared me and told me nothing was wrong with me and implored me to get back to work.”

He adds, “The chairman of my company himself met me and told me to not worry about anything. It took me three to four months to come out of it, but I think I came out of it stronger and hungrier to prove myself.”

Sreeram is of the view that the whole incident at the young age of 31 left him wiser and stronger. He recalls how his mother was concerned that he might never be able to lead a normal life again. He overheard a conversation where she was bemoaning his condition and wondering if her son would live a simple normal life ever again.

“I recall my mom telling someone that I should have never left the USA in the first place. I think, in all fairness, I fought hard mentally and physically. I was at an age when giving up was not an option,” he explains.

Sreeram picked himself up from that point and started a strict regimen of exercises, long walks, and slow jogging, which culminated after many years in a successful 5km run in 38 minutes at the Coimbatore Marathon. His aspiration was to run the 10km race next and eventually the half marathon for which he started practicing in the right earnest. But a small accident during one of the training sessions put an end to all this. He gave up jogging for the moment and started practicing yoga to get stronger mentally.

The other challenge that Sreeram faced on returning to India was the different styles of work cultures in the USA and here. He recalls that in the USA, a research job usually means interacting with a select group of people and reading a lot of technical papers and running experiments in a lab and coming up with insight and